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ON A SUNNY AFTERNOON in March 2017, Sudhanshu Mani—then General Manager at the Integral Coach Factory (ICF) in Chennai—received a call informing him that the Railway Board was turning down the ICF’s proposal to manufacture indigenous semi-high-speed trains. The ICF had asked for a go-ahead to design and make two such trains.

The very next day, Mani landed up at the Delhi residence of A.K. Mital, then Chairman of the Railway Board, without any prior appointment. After an hour-long meeting with Mital, Mani left for Chennai. As the flight touched down, he received news that the project was on.

In the next 18 months, a core ICF team under Mani delivered the first rake of ‘Train 18’—called so because of the manufacturing year being 2018—to run

THE VANDE BHARAT IMPACT



JUMP IN INVESTMENTS IN MODERN COACHES WITH BETTER AMENITIES AND SAFETY FEATURES



VANDE BHARAT BRAND TO BE PRESENT ACROSS SEGMENTS—CHAIR CAR, SLEEPER, METRO, AND BULLET



VANDE BHARAT IS SET TO REPLACE ALL RAJDHANI TRAINS IN THE FUTURE



IT HAS PUSHED RAILWAY MANUFACTURING WITH UNITS SET UP FOR WHEELS AND OTHER ANCILLARIES



TRACKS NEED TO BE UPGRADED FOR VANDE BHARAT TO ATTAIN TOP SPEED OF 160 KMPH

OPERATIONAL

Mar
2017



APPROVAL OF VANDE BHARAT COACHES

Dec
2018



FIRST SUCCESSFUL TRIALS AT SPEEDS OF 183 KMPH

Feb
2019



LAUNCH OF FIRST VANDE BHARAT TRAIN ON DELHI-VARANASI ROUTE